

**Elon Musk = Iron Man?**

The real life Tony Stark just started building himself a real Iron Man lab. By the time you're reading this his new gesture based system will already be out.

**The hero of the unlikely**

Meet the man who invented modern probability. Andrei Kolmogorov came up with many theories including the "drunkard's walk" <http://dgit.in/18mhmvu>

# Major Threat

Read on for some paranoia-worthy news such as a significant rise in malware targeting online banking and online snooping by cyber agencies that could lead to future leaders being blackmailed

## Malware targeting online banking up by 29% in Q2'13

According to Trend Micro's Q2 2013 security round-up report, online banking malware saw a 29% increase from the previous quarter – going from 1,13,000 to 1,46,000 infections. The report expresses concern over the increased online banking threats and availability of sophisticated and inexpensive malware toolkits. The report also warns users about the increasing hazards of online banking.

"We found an online banking malware that modifies an infected computer's Hosts file to redirect a customer of certain banks to phishing sites. We also saw more Citadel variants (detected as ZBOT) targeting different financial service institutions. These malware not only target the big banks but also smaller ones, including those that exclusively cater to online banking customers. As predicted, cybercriminals carried out developments in malware distribution and refinement for existing tools," said Dhanya Thakkar, Managing Director, India & SAARC, Trend Micro.

As per the report, more online banking threats were seen in different countries this quarter, specifically in Brazil, South Korea, India and Japan. These highlighted the need for increased awareness of online banking security. Cybercriminals also came up with more diverse attacks that used various social engineering

lures, single sign-on (SSO) and multiprotocol services, and blogging platforms for their malicious schemes.

The 'fakebank' malware spotted this quarter spoofs legitimate apps. It contains specific Android application package files (APKs), which it copies to a device's Secure Digital (SD) card. Using the APK files, the malware displays icons and a user interface that imitates legitimate banking apps. This technique is reminiscent of PC banking trojans that monitor users' browsing behaviors and spoofs banking sites.

As predicted, cybercriminals have not generated completely new threats and instead opted to repackage old ones. The online banking malware volume significantly increased this quarter due in part to the rise in the Zeus/ZBOT malware volume in the wild. Online banking threats are spreading across the globe and are no longer concentrated in certain regions like Europe and the Americas.

In the cyber criminal underground, the 'carberp' source code was leaked, making the creation of banking Trojans even easier for the bad guys. Meanwhile, other online banking trojan toolkits like Zeus, SpyEye and Ice IX are already available for free, making it easier for any skilled hacker to obtain their source codes.

## Cyber snooping by security agencies could threaten future leaders, says former Indian bureaucrat

KC Singh, the former Secretary of the Ministry of External Affairs, expressed concern over the recent revelations of data mining by the U.S. government. According to Singh, cyber-snooping might help in the war against terror but could be misused to blackmail others.



KC Singh, a former senior foreign affairs bureaucrat, spoke at the Hackers Conference in New Delhi

He was addressing 'The Hackers Conference 2013' held in New Delhi in August.

"Through legal means they (USA) are scooping and dredging up huge amounts of information. (They are) only looking at bad guys who are communicating with each other, but you can retrieve it (the information) many years later for blackmail or whatever you want," Singh said at the confer-

ence, held to discuss the state of global internet security.

He pointed out that the US government supports its surveillance programme, claiming it to be in the interest of its citizens and help check terror activity. But such capabilities could be used to blackmail others.

"Somebody in this room becomes Prime Minister of India 20 years from now. They will go into your background and scoop it up to see what were you doing, what were the mails you were exchanging. That becomes the very instrument (for) blackmailing future leaders of any country," Singh added.

The former secretary also called for global cooperation on cyber security related issues. He stressed the need for stringent international laws in this space.

Also speaking at the conference, Sri Lankan High Commissioner to India, Prasad Kariyawasam highlighted the need for developing regional capability in cyberspace. "We have to catch up with the world, but before that, challenges of the cyber world must be handled properly. Every aspect of our life in the times to come may be controlled by this (cyber) revolution. Unless you have proper defences you cannot go forward," Kariyawasam added.

The Hackers Conference 2013 saw the participation of the information security industry and the cyber community along with policymakers and government representatives for cyber security. 